

VIRAT KOHLI

Complete Biography, Cricket Career, Records, Achievements & Legacy

Prepared as a comprehensive reference profile

1. Personal Profile

Full name: Virat Kohli

Born: 5 November 1988

Birthplace: Delhi, India

Batting: Right-handed

Bowling: Right-arm medium

International debut: ODI, 2008

Role: Batter

Major domestic/club association: Royal Challengers Bengaluru in the IPL.

Virat Kohli is one of India's most prominent cricketers and one of the defining batters of the modern era. The BCCI describes him as a disciplined, highly competitive player whose career began with the 2008 Under-19 World Cup title and quickly developed into a record-filled international career.

2. Childhood & Early Life

Kohli was born in Delhi and developed a strong interest in cricket during childhood. He trained at the West Delhi Cricket Academy, where his batting developed under structured coaching. His early cricket was characterized by competitiveness, concentration and a desire to perform.

His family supported his cricket ambitions. His father, Prem Kohli, played an important role in encouraging his training and development. Kohli's early experiences helped create the intense work ethic that later became a central part of his public identity.

3. Under-19 Career & 2008 World Cup

Kohli rose rapidly through India's junior cricket system. In 2008 he captained India at the ICC Under-19 Cricket World Cup in Malaysia and led the team to the championship.

ICC records note that he scored 235 runs in six matches in that tournament, including a century against the West Indies. His U-19 success also helped him secure an early IPL opportunity and accelerated his transition toward senior cricket.

4. International Debut

Kohli made his ODI debut against Sri Lanka in 2008. He initially had to establish himself in a strong Indian batting lineup, but his ability to score under pressure and his performances in run chases quickly made him an important member of the side.

His first ODI century came in 2009. Over the following years he became known as a dependable limited-overs batter, particularly while chasing targets.

5. 2011 Cricket World Cup

Kohli was part of India's 2011 World Cup-winning squad. He scored a century in India's opening match of the tournament against Bangladesh.

In the final against Sri Lanka, he made 35 and shared an important partnership with Gautam Gambhir after early wickets. India won the final in Mumbai, giving Kohli his first senior men's World Cup title.

6. Rise as an ODI Great

Kohli's ODI career became defined by consistency, chase batting and rapid accumulation of milestones. He developed a reputation for converting starts into large scores and for remaining calm late in innings.

In 2012, his unbeaten 133 off 86 balls against Sri Lanka in the CB Series became one of the innings that established his global reputation. He subsequently became one of the fastest players to numerous ODI run milestones.

7. Test Debut & Development

Kohli made his Test debut in 2011 against the West Indies. His early Test career developed through tours of Australia and other challenging environments.

During the 2014–15 Australia tour, he scored four centuries in the series. On his first Test as India's captain in Adelaide, he scored 115 and 141, becoming the first visiting batter since 1961 to score two centuries in a Test in Australia.

8. Test Captaincy

Kohli became India's Test captain in 2014 and ultimately led the side in 68 Tests, winning 40. That makes him India's most successful Test captain by wins.

Under his leadership India became a stronger overseas Test side. India won a Test series in Sri Lanka, won series in the West Indies and, most famously, won the 2018–19 Test series in Australia—the first time India had won a Test series there.

India also reached the inaugural ICC World Test Championship final in 2021 and spent five consecutive years at No.1 in the ICC Test rankings during the broader period of Kohli's leadership.

9. 2016–2018 Peak Test Years

Kohli's peak Test period included a remarkable run of batting and leadership performances. ICC records highlight his double centuries across four consecutive Test series, a sequence that surpassed a record previously associated with Don Bradman and Rahul Dravid.

In 2018 he scored 593 runs in England and later led India to the historic Test series victory in Australia. His 2018 season earned him the ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year, Test Player of the Year and ODI Player of the Year awards—the first clean sweep of the senior men's ICC awards.

10. 2019–2021

Kohli remained a major part of India's batting and leadership group. His captaincy period emphasized fitness, fast bowling depth, aggressive fielding and a strong competitive culture.

India reached the final of the inaugural World Test Championship in 2021. Kohli continued to be among the world's leading batters across formats, even as international cricket became increasingly demanding.

11. 2022 Pakistan Classic

At the 2022 T20 World Cup in Melbourne, Kohli produced one of the most famous innings of his career: an unbeaten 82 against Pakistan. Chasing 160, India were under severe pressure before Kohli and Hardik Pandya rebuilt the innings.

The innings became famous for its late acceleration, including straight sixes against Haris Rauf, and for the way Kohli controlled the chase in the final overs.

12. 2023 ODI World Cup

The 2023 ODI World Cup was one of Kohli's greatest individual tournaments. He scored 765 runs in 11 matches, including three centuries and six fifties.

He broke Sachin Tendulkar's record of 49 ODI centuries by scoring his 50th ODI hundred in the semi-final against New Zealand in Mumbai. He finished as the tournament's leading run-scorer and received the Player of the Tournament award.

ICC records identify his 765 runs as the highest aggregate by a batter in a single men's ODI World Cup edition at the time.

13. 2024 T20 World Cup

In the 2024 T20 World Cup final against South Africa, Kohli scored 76 from 59 balls. His innings provided stability in a difficult final and helped India post a competitive total.

India won the final and ended an 11-year wait for a senior men's ICC trophy. Kohli was named Player of the Match and announced his retirement from T20 internationals immediately after the victory.

14. 2025 Champions Trophy

In the 2025 ICC Champions Trophy, Kohli passed 14,000 ODI runs and became only the third batter to reach that landmark, after Sachin Tendulkar and Kumar Sangakkara.

He scored a century against Pakistan in the tournament and contributed to India's title-winning campaign. The victory added another ICC trophy to his international résumé.

15. Test Retirement

Kohli announced his retirement from Test cricket in May 2025 after 123 Tests. He finished with 9,230 runs at an average of 46.85, including 30 centuries and 31 fifties.

He ended his Test career as India's most successful Test captain, with 40 wins in 68 matches. His red-ball legacy includes overseas success, major home performances and a transformation in India's competitive approach to Test cricket.

16. ODI Career & Statistics

According to the BCCI profile, Kohli's ODI record stands at 314 matches, 302 innings, 14,941 runs, a highest score of 183, an average of 58.59 and a strike rate of 93.95. The profile lists 54 ODI centuries and 79 fifties.

His ODI career has been especially notable for run chases, consistency and conversion of fifties into hundreds. He became the first player to reach 50 ODI centuries and crossed 14,000 ODI runs in 2025.

17. T20I Career & Statistics

The BCCI profile lists Kohli's T20I career at 125 matches, 4,188 runs, a highest score of 122*, an average of 48.70 and a strike rate of 137.04. It lists one T20I century and 38 fifties.

He was Player of the Tournament at the 2014 and 2016 T20 World Cups and became particularly associated with high-pressure run chases.

18. Test Statistics

The BCCI profile lists 123 Tests, 9,230 runs, a highest score of 254*, an average of 46.85, 30 centuries and 31 fifties.

ICC notes several major Test records: seven Test centuries in Australia, four consecutive series with double centuries, a peak ICC Test batting rating of 937, and India's first Test series victory in Australia under his captaincy.

19. Career Statistics – Quick Table

Format	Matches	Runs	Highest	Average	100s	50s
Test	123	9,230	254*	46.85	30	31
ODI	314	14,941	183	58.59	54	79
T20I	125	4,188	122*	48.70	1	38

Statistics above are based on the BCCI profile available in September 2026; international figures can change for active formats.

20. Captaincy Record

Test captaincy: 68 matches, 40 wins. India's most successful Test captain by wins.

Leadership achievements: first Test series win in Australia; No.1 Test ranking; World Test Championship final appearance; overseas series wins in Sri Lanka and West Indies.

His captaincy emphasized fitness, pace bowling, aggression and a refusal to treat overseas Tests as defensive contests.

21. IPL Career & Royal Challengers Bengaluru

Kohli has been associated with Royal Challengers Bengaluru since the IPL's early years and became the franchise's defining batter and a long-term leader.

His IPL career is notable for huge run totals, consistency and several record-setting seasons. His relationship with RCB has also made him one of the most recognizable players in the league.

22. Batting Style

Kohli combines a technically controlled base with aggressive intent. His cover drive, straight drive, wrist work and ability to find gaps are among his recognizable strengths.

In limited-overs cricket, he is particularly effective at pacing a chase: minimizing unnecessary risk early, building partnerships, rotating the strike and accelerating when the required rate rises.

23. Fitness & Fielding

Fitness became a major part of Kohli's cricketing identity. He emphasized conditioning, nutrition, recovery and athletic fielding.

His standards influenced the wider Indian cricket environment, contributing to an increased emphasis on physical conditioning and professional preparation.

24. Mentality & Leadership Style

Kohli is known for emotional intensity, competitiveness and strong self-belief. His leadership often stressed preparation, aggression and accountability.

His public career also demonstrated how elite athletes can use routines, fitness and disciplined preparation to sustain performance over a long international career.

25. Awards & Honours

Arjuna Award: 2013.

Padma Shri: 2017.

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna: 2018.

ICC ODI Player of the Year: 2012, 2017, 2018, 2020 and 2023.

ICC Test Player of the Year: 2018.

Sir Garfield Sobers Trophy / ICC Men's Cricketer of the Year: 2017, 2018 and 2020.

ICC Spirit of Cricket Award: 2019.

ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Decade: 2020.

ICC Men's Cricketer of the Decade: 2020.

26. Major Records & Milestones

- 50 ODI centuries — the first batter to reach the milestone.
- 14,000+ ODI runs — reached in 2025 as the third batter in history.
- 765 runs — most runs in a single men's ODI World Cup edition at the time.
- 30 Test centuries and 9,230 Test runs.
- Seven Test centuries in Australia — the most by an Indian batter there.
- Four consecutive Test series with a double century.
- 40 Test wins as captain — India's record.
- Two T20 World Cup Player of the Tournament awards (2014 and 2016).

27. Memorable Innings

133* vs Sri Lanka, 2012: A spectacular chase that elevated his international reputation.

82* vs Pakistan, 2022: A famous MCG T20 World Cup chase.

Virat's 254* vs South Africa, 2019: His highest Test score.

50th ODI century vs New Zealand, 2023: A record-breaking World Cup moment.

76 vs South Africa, 2024: A match-winning contribution in the T20 World Cup final.

Century vs Pakistan, Champions Trophy 2025: Another major tournament milestone.

28. India Career Timeline

2008: U-19 World Cup captain; ODI debut.

2009: First ODI century.

2010: T20I debut.

2011: Test debut and senior World Cup winner.

2012: ICC ODI Player of the Year.

2014: Became India's Test captain; major Australia series.

2015–17: Rapid growth as all-format leader and batter.

2018: Historic Test series win in Australia; ICC award sweep.

2019: Continued as one of world's leading batters.

2021: Led India to inaugural WTC final.

2022: 82* vs Pakistan at MCG.

2023: 50th ODI hundred; 765-run World Cup.

2024: T20 World Cup final heroics; T20I retirement.

2025: Champions Trophy title; 14,000 ODI runs; Test retirement.

29. Impact on Indian Cricket

Kohli's influence is broader than statistics. He helped normalize elite fitness standards, intense preparation and aggressive competitive behavior. His Test leadership contributed to India's confidence overseas and to a stronger

fast-bowling culture.

He also became a major bridge between generations of Indian cricket, carrying the expectations created by earlier greats while establishing records of his own.

30. Public Image & Global Influence

Kohli became one of cricket's most recognizable global sports personalities. His intensity, fashion, fitness, commercial visibility and social-media presence expanded his influence beyond cricket.

At the same time, his cricketing reputation remains grounded in performances: hundreds across formats, major tournament innings, overseas Test success and longevity at the international level.

31. Personal Life

Kohli married Indian actress Anushka Sharma in 2017. They have children and maintain a relatively private family life compared with the scale of their public profiles.

Because family details are personal and can change, this profile focuses primarily on Kohli's public professional career.

32. Interesting Facts

- Jersey number: 18.
- Born in Delhi on 5 November 1988.
- Right-handed batter.
- Captained India to the 2008 U-19 World Cup title.
- Has represented India at multiple ODI and T20 World Cups.
- Has played a central role in several historic India-Australia contests.
- Became the first player to reach 50 ODI centuries.
- Was named ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Decade and ICC Men's Cricketer of the Decade in 2020.

33. Legacy

Virat Kohli's legacy rests on four connected themes: elite batting, high-pressure performances, transformational leadership and professional discipline. His career crossed major changes in cricket—from the rise of T20 leagues to increasingly demanding international schedules.

His numbers place him among the most productive batters in international cricket, while his leadership helped redefine India's approach to Test cricket. His 2023 World Cup, 2024 T20 World Cup final and 2025 Champions Trophy performances added major late-career chapters to an already historic career.

34. Conclusion

Virat Kohli is more than a collection of records. He represents a generation of Indian cricket built around fitness, ambition, self-belief and a willingness to compete aggressively against the world's best teams.

From an Under-19 World Cup-winning captain in 2008 to an international legend with World Cup titles, record-breaking ODI achievements, a historic Test captaincy and decades of influence, Kohli's career has become an important part of modern cricket history.

Sources & Verification

BCCI – Virat Kohli player profile — Current profile containing biography, batting/bowling statistics and awards.

BCCI – Legendary Test career release — Official BCCI statement covering his 123-Test career, 9,230 runs, 30 centuries and captaincy record.

ICC – Records achieved during Kohli's Test career — ICC review of Test records, captaincy milestones and overseas achievements.

ICC – Evolution of Virat Kohli — ICC career retrospective covering his World Cups, captaincy and major milestones.

ICC – Champions Trophy 2025 — ICC report on Kohli crossing 14,000 ODI runs and his 2025 tournament performance.

Note: This document is a comprehensive educational profile, not an official biography. Statistics are based primarily on official BCCI and ICC sources available in September 2026. Active-format statistics may change after publication.

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Complete Biography, Cricket Career, Personal Life, Records & Legacy

Personal-life section is limited to publicly reported, non-sensitive information.

1. Personal Life & Family

Virat Kohli was born on 5 November 1988 in Delhi, India. He is the youngest child of Prem Kohli and Saroj Kohli and has an elder brother, Vikas, and an elder sister, Bhawna.

Kohli married Indian actress and producer Anushka Sharma in December 2017. Their relationship and marriage have been widely reported, and the couple generally keeps their family life away from unnecessary public attention.

They have two children: daughter Vamika and son Akaay. The family maintains a relatively private lifestyle, and the parents have repeatedly sought to protect their children's privacy.

2. Education & School Life

Kohli attended Vishal Bharti Public School in Delhi and later Saviour Convent School in Paschim Vihar. As his cricket commitments increased during his teenage years, cricket became his primary career focus.

He did not pursue a conventional college education; instead, his professional cricket pathway developed through Delhi cricket, the India Under-19 system and eventually the senior national team.

3. Parents & Childhood Influence

His father, Prem Kohli, was a lawyer and was an important supporter of Virat's early cricket ambitions. Kohli has spoken publicly about the importance of his father in his childhood and development.

One of the most frequently discussed moments in his early life is the death of his father in 2006. Kohli continued to pursue cricket afterward, and the experience became an important part of the story of his mental resilience and determination.

4. Marriage & Children

Kohli and Anushka Sharma married in a private ceremony in Italy in 2017. They have built a public profile that combines sport and entertainment while keeping many details of their family life private.

The couple welcomed their daughter Vamika in 2021 and their son Akaay in 2024. Their children's photographs and personal details are generally kept private, so this PDF does not include unnecessary identifying information.

5. Lifestyle, Fitness & Diet

Fitness is one of the strongest themes associated with Kohli's career. He transformed his conditioning during the early part of his international career and subsequently became known for structured training, athletic fielding, recovery and disciplined nutrition.

His fitness approach has influenced the wider culture of Indian cricket. He has often emphasized consistency, preparation and making professional choices that support long-term performance.

6. Business & Brand Ventures

Kohli has developed interests outside cricket, including the One8 brand and other commercial ventures. His public business profile has included fashion, fitness, hospitality and sports-related projects.

One8 has become one of the most recognizable brands associated with his name. These ventures reflect his broader influence as a sports personality rather than being part of his cricket statistics.

7. Charity & Social Initiatives

Kohli and Anushka Sharma have supported charitable and social causes through the Virat Kohli Foundation and related initiatives. The foundation has worked around sports development and support for people and causes in need.

Kohli has also participated in public campaigns connected to animal welfare, health, children's causes and sports. The exact programs and partnerships can change over time, so current official announcements are the best source for active initiatives.

8. Personality & Public Image

Kohli is known for an intense competitive personality, expressive celebrations and a strong emphasis on self-belief. His public image has evolved from an energetic young cricketer into that of a senior professional athlete.

His popularity extends well beyond cricket. He is one of India's most recognizable sports personalities and has a major global following.

9. Interests & Influences

Kohli has spoken about his admiration for sport and elite athletes. In an ICC feature, he identified Andre Agassi's autobiography 'Open' as a book he particularly liked because of its honest account of the ups and downs of a champion's career.

He has also frequently discussed the importance of mindset, discipline, fitness and learning from difficult periods.

10. Complete Career Summary

Kohli captained India to the 2008 Under-19 World Cup title, debuted internationally in 2008, became one of India's leading ODI batters, led the Test side to historic overseas success and collected major ICC tournament victories.

His major international titles include the 2011 ODI World Cup, 2013 Champions Trophy, 2024 T20 World Cup and 2025 Champions Trophy. His 2023 ODI World Cup campaign included 765 runs and a record 50th ODI century.

He retired from T20 internationals after the 2024 World Cup and from Test cricket in 2025, while continuing his ODI career.

Personal Life — Quick Reference

Category	Information
Born	5 November 1988, Delhi, India
Parents	Prem Kohli and Saroj Kohli
Siblings	Elder brother Vikas; elder sister Bhawna
Spouse	Anushka Sharma
Marriage	2017
Children	Daughter Vamika; son Akaay
Profession	International cricketer / batter
IPL team	Royal Challengers Bengaluru
Jersey number	18

Sources

- ICC — Virat Kohli player profile and career records.
- BCCI — Virat Kohli official player profile and career statistics.
- ICC — career retrospective and major tournament reports.
- ICC — feature on Kohli's reading interests.
- Publicly available interviews and official information concerning his family and foundation.

Note: Personal information is included only at a general, publicly reported level. No private addresses, contact information, school schedules, or other sensitive details are included.